

forget Zoho Docs but that would be our undoing. The Zoho Office Suite is a very comprehensive web-based service that includes most of the commonly sought after office applications like word processors, spreadsheets, presentations and databases along with other rarer online applications in this segment such as customer relationship management (CRM) tools, project management tools, invoicing applications and other enterprise grade services.

Zoho Corporation, that developed these tools, was formerly known as AdventNet Inc and has a long history of creating productivity and enterprise software-as-a-solution services. But its biggest claim to fame in the broader market has been its Zoho Docs application which is a very popular online documentation management service that is built around storage, management and sharing services. The application supports a large variety of file formats across all formats, from images to videos.



Zoho Office Suite and Docs are built on an open API and have their own brand of office applications called 'Writer' (word processing), 'Sheet' (spreadsheet), 'Show' (presentation), 'Planner' (project management), 'Creator' and 'Meeting'. An interesting feature of Zoho tools is their apparent harmony with their competition. This is seen in the Zoho plug-ins available for Microsoft Word and Excel, OpenOffice.org, Firefox and the presence of Zoho add-ons and app in the Google store. All these cross integrations exist despite their direct competition with each other in the office suite arena.

It's necessary to clarify that although there's a comprehensive Zoho Office Suite with numerous features, the only free component is Zoho Docs. The Zoho Docs free usage registration gives users access to 5 GB of online storage for their files as well as access to the word processor, spreadsheet and presentation tools. The rest of the features bundle is available only for monthly subscribers. The free version also allows for a highly efficient online sharing experience as well as detailed document version history.

Zoho Docs was one the first services to achieve a high standard of real-time collaboration between users on a single file. This level of collaborative work support makes it the preferred software for over 10 million users across the world. In this regard, the only purely online service to be greater in adop-